the Contracting Parties approved the Four Ramsar Strategic Plan for 2016-2024. The World Wetlands Day is celebrated on 2nd February every year. The Montreux Record is "a register of wetland sites on the List of Wetlands of International Importance where changes in ecological character have occurred, are occurring, or are likely to occur as a result of technological developments, pollution or other human interference". It is maintained as part of the Ramsar List. Under the three pillars of the Convention, the contracting parties commit to:

Activity

Explore how the application of Artificial Intelligence can help conserve environment better.

1) Work towards the wise use of all their wetlands;
2) Designate suitable wetlands for the list of Wetlands of International Importance (the "Ramsar List") and ensure their effective management;
3) Cooperate internationally on trans-boundary wetlands, shared wetland systems and shared species.

The World Heritage Convention, 1972

The World Heritage Convention in 1972 sought to identify and protect the world's natural and cultural heritage considered to be of Outstanding Universal Value. It defines the criteria for the selection of natural and cultural sites to be inscribed on the UNESCO's World Heritage List. The enforcement of the Convention is carried out through the Operational Guidelines, which reflects the procedures for new inscriptions, site protection, danger-listings, and the provision of international assistance under the World Heritage Fund. Moreover, the Convention is administered by the World Heritage Committee supported by the UNESCO World Heritage Centre, which is the secretariat of the Convention based at Paris. The Committee is also assisted by the three technical advisory committees – IUCN, ICOMOS and ICCROM.

Activity

Explore the concept of Blue Economy and its relevance.

UN Conference on the Human Environment (1972)

The UN Conference on the Human Environment or the Stockholm Conference was the first major multilateral conference on environmental issues. It was held at Stockholm in Sweden from June 5-16, 1972. The conference, which was attended by delegations from 114 governments, was a breakthrough by scripting a new discourse on environmental politics by laying the foundation of a global environmental governance regime based on international cooperation. The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), was also an institutional innovation of the Stockholm Conference.

Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild flora and fauna (CITES), 1973

As an output of the 1973 resolution of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), the CITES, which took place at Washington, seeks to control or prevent international commercial trade in endangered species or products derived from them. It is not a direct attempt towards the

12th_Political Science_Unit_12.indd 279 07/12/2022 13:26:31